Water Treatment

Exam code: 0620 & 0971

Download PDF

Written by: Caroline Carroll
Reviewed by: Richard Boole
Updated on 17 January 2026

SaveMyExams

Did this video help you? Yes No

Help me understand

Water treatment

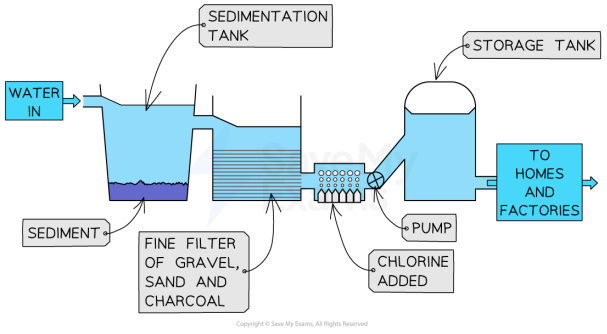
- Untreated water contains **soluble** and **insoluble** impurities
  - Insoluble impurities include soil, pieces of plants and other organic matter
  - Soluble impurities include dissolved calcium, metallic compounds and inorganic pollutants

1. The first step of water treatment is **sedimentation and filtration** to remove solids
   - Water is pumped into sedimentation tanks and allowed to stand for a few hours
   - Mud, sand and other particles will fall to the bottom of the tank due to gravity and form a layer of sediment
   - The water is then **filtered** through sand and gravel to remove smaller particles
2. The second step is **filtration through carbon** (charcoal)
   - This removes unpleasant tastes and odours
3. The final step is **chlorination**
   - Bacteria and other microorganisms are too small to be trapped by the filters
   - So, chlorine is carefully added to the water supply to kill microbes
   - Cholera and typhoid are examples of bacterial diseases which can arise from the consumption of untreated water

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it



The stages of treating water are sedimentation, filtration with carbon and chlorination

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Exam questions on water treatment often focus on the purpose of each stage of the process.

Teacher only

New! Exclusive Teacher-Only Questions

- Fresh, expert-written questions
- Students can't access them
- Fair accurate tests - built fast

Explore in Test Builder

Test yourself

Flashcards

Was this revision note helpful? Yes No

Resources

Learning Hub

Scholarship

Join

Past Papers

Solution Banks

Sitemap

Dashboard

Overview

Brand ambassador

Profile

Subscription

Settings

Log out

Company

About us

Exam Specificity

Content Quality

Promotions

Jobs

Terms

Privacy

Cookie Policy

Help and Support

Subjects

Biology

Chemistry

Physics

Maths

Geography

English Literature

Psychology

All Subjects

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.